Inter-country tensions have been building up in the other domains, too, disparities in ***savings rates*** across nations have often led to acrimonious debate and search for first cause. It has been suggested[16] that China's huge savings rate may not be entirely because of domestic structural factors in China but a response to the fact that the savings rate in the U S dropped sharply between 1960 and 2010.

The above-discussed adjustments/changes/shifts give rise to economic turmoil and crisis and, in addition, are politically sensitive matters that can lead to protectionism, which can do more harm than good. It is important for us to recognize that none of these structural shifts are caused by the actions of any one individual or nation. Millions of little actions and thousands of scientific discoveries over decades and human inventiveness in general have given rise to globalization and we have inherited the world we have. It is for us to take the givens as given and use collective bodies such as the G-20 to ensure that we do not fall victim to *protectionism.* It is important to remember that through all this turmoil the global pie/opportunities *(basically, due to the ongoing process of globalisation about which even the developing nations have no doubt who questioned its very rationale while the WTO was in the process of emergence, i.e. 1985-1994)* is expanding. Hence, by having effective coordinated action, it is possible to convert what appears at first as adversity into advantage.

Presently, we see very high levels of private consumption and government expenditures (in relation to their GDPs) among the advanced economies. In such case, a *prolonged slowdown* could place further pressure on their budgetary balances and household savings (that are already low) and adversely impact investment and their potential growth. Thus the possibility of low growth setting off a vicious cycle of ***higher debt*** and ***low growth*** cannot be ruled out.

This is why, even when the emerging economies (including India) witnessed a slowdown in growth in 2011 due to the renewed bouts of uncertainty in the global economy, there are reasons to suggest that the growth prospects of most of these economies remain robust in the medium to long run – due to various factors that drive growth such as[17]:

(i) demographics,